



Contents

6 Introduction

8 THE DEVELOPMENT OF HERBAL MEDICINE

10 How Medicinal Plants Work

14 Active Constituents

17 Quality Control

18 Early Origins to the 19th Century

28 20th Century Onward

32 Herbal Traditions of the World

32 Europe

36 India and the Middle East

40 China, Japan, and Southeast Asia

44 Africa

46 Australia and New Zealand

48 North America

52 South America

54 KEY MEDICINAL PLANTS

A visual guide to 100 key herbs from around the world with details of their habitat, constituents, actions, traditional and current uses, and information on the latest research. Also included are key preparations and practical self-help uses.

156 OTHER MEDICINAL PLANTS

450 other herbs from different herbal traditions with descriptions of their therapeutic properties and past and present uses.

284 HERBAL REMEDIES FOR HOME USE

286 Growing Medicinal Plants

288 Harvesting & Processing

290 Making Herbal Remedies

298 Using Herbal Remedies Safely

299 Remedies for Common Ailments

320 Consulting an Herbal Practitioner

321 Glossary

322 Bibliography

323 General Index

332 Index of Herbs by Ailment

336 Useful Addresses & Acknowledgments